

Ways to stay accountable without self-flagellation

- Change your language – try to steer ‘away from blame-based language and talk more about responsibility. For example, change ‘I’m to blame for all of this financial stress’ to ‘It’s my responsibility to resolve these financial issues’.
- Find a positive way of tracking your progress, and check in frequently.
- Don’t tiptoe around things or shy away from the facts. Practise talking aloud about your finances, even if it’s just in the mirror.
- Find like-minded people to talk about money with, and be honest with one another.
- Use a budgeting app that will warn you if you’re spending a bit too much, and *heed its advice*.

Dealing with external judgement

As someone who is naturally very thin-skinned, I completely understand how much it hurts to be judged for having difficulties in your relationship with money, especially when those difficulties have manifested into something tangible and life-affecting, such as debt or an inability to save for your goals. We bear the weight of other people’s judgements of us, or worse, the judgements that we *imagine* that they’re making about us, like ankle weights. We might not always be overtly aware of them, but they make everything harder, slower and